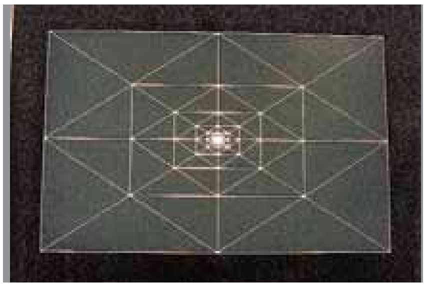


The screen for testing Screen Pixel Resolution

objects, and fusion or merging of pixels.

Among the 15-inch monitors, the Compaq MV540 displayed diagonal lines perfectly and the shape of the rectangle and the circle was also almost perfect. It scored a brilliant 4 points out of a maximum of 5. Krypton 500LR was its nearest rival with a score of 3.8; the only visible difference was that the lines were slightly more jagged as compared to the Compaq MV540. The rest of the 15-inch monitors scored close to 3 points, which is quite acceptable.

In the 17-inch category, LG StudioWorks 700s, Philips 107s, Philips 107T, Proview 787N and Viewsonic G73f vied for the top spot, each scoring an impeccable 4 points.

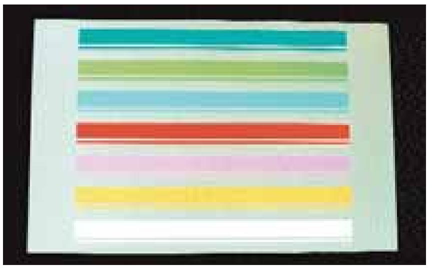
There was a tie between Compaq MV940, Sony CPD-G420, and Viewsonic E90 in the 19-inch category. Each scored 4.1 points.

In the 21- and 22-inch category also there was very close competition. Sony CPD-G520 won by a hair's breadth, scoring 4.1—just 0.1 points extra over the entries from Viewsonic and Philips.

Colour and Grayscale

This test, which had the highest weightage in the overall score, helps evaluate how well the monitor is able to reproduce colour. It also checks for any ghosting and streaking that might occur with different colour shades, brightness and contrast as well as overlapping of darker or lighter shades on other colours. The results of this test would prove quite interesting for photo and video professionals as well as those who work in the print industry and need to work specifically with colours. For home or office users, this test might not hold too much importance as general applications like Office suites will not be able to highlight the difference.

The Proview PA-566 came out on top here. It scored an excellent 33.6 points, edging out Viewsonic E53 by just about a point. A decent score in this category would be over 30, and almost all 15-inch monitors made that cut, except for LG StudioWorks 563N—one could see a lot of colour and midrange streaking and its performance in white and black level shift was also below average.



The screen in a Colour and Grayscale test

In the 17-inch category, Samsung Syncmaster 753s was a clear winner with a score of 37.1. No monitor came even close to this score. It performed extremely well in all the tests, and one couldn't observe any sort of ghosting and streaking effect. Viewsonic E771 was the second best, scoring 35.1 points.

There was a neck and neck fight between Samsung SyncMaster 955DF and Compaq MV-940 in the 19-inch category; SyncMaster 955DF emerged as the winner. Compaq MV-940 lost out on account of the high amount of ghosting and streaking.

The NEC AccuSync 95F was the only monitor which did not perform well in this test. It performed poorly in the Streaking and Ghosting test and displayed an average performance in the colour purity test as well. It surely shouldn't be on your list if you are a designer or need to work for print publications.

In the 21- and 22-inch category, Philips 201B performed brilliantly. Viewsonic P220F too put up an extremely respectable performance, except in the Midrange Streaking test. LG StudioWorks N2200P's performance was not up to the mark at all and was especially bad in the Streaking and Ghosting test.

Miscellaneous Effects

This test is a combination of several small but important tests. It checks for screen uniformity which basically determines whether the image will be clear throughout without variation in colour, contrast and brightness. It also includes a flicker test, which checks for visible flicker at various resolutions. Defocus, Blooming and Halos tells us whether or not lines, bars or other objects will appear uniformly or not.

In the 15-inch category, Viewsonic E53 came out tops, with a score of 16.6 points. This was the only monitor to display a resolution of 1024x768 at 75 Hz. Proview PA-566 too performed well, scoring 16.1 points. The only place it lost out was in the Dark Screen test, which checks for reflection off the screen. Compaq MV-540 was a disappointment. Its poor performance was especially visible in the Flicker, Defocus, Blooming and Halos and Dark Screen test.

Among the 17-inch monitors, both Samsung SyncMaster 753 DFX and Viewsonic G73f emerged winners in this test, scoring 18 points each. Both performed exceptionally well in all the tests. For the second place also there was a tie between three models: Benq V771, Benq G773 and Samsung SyncMaster 753S, each scoring 17.6 points.

In the 19-inch category, Compaq MV 940 was the top performer, scoring 19.3

5 Steps to a Perfectly Calibrated Machine

How do you get your brand new monitor to display an image as close to perfection as possible? The answer is to calibrate and characterise the monitor. Calibration removes colour casts and sets a known white point on your monitor as a reference point for variations in brightness and contrast, whereas characterisation creates a monitor profile for use with a colour management system. The colour profile of the monitor must be as accurate as possible.

Specialised software are available for calibrating monitors. For PCs running Windows, the most commonly used program is Adobe Gamma, which comes bundled with most Adobe products.

To calibrate your monitor, go to ***Start > Run > Control Panel > Adobe Gamma***. Select the 'Step by Step' wizard. It will prompt you to give a unique profile name. Next, it will prompt you to adjust the brightness and contrast so that the centre box is as dark as possible. It will then display the phosphors that your monitor displays.

Adjust your gamma settings and then adjust the Hardware white point according to your preferences. Save your profile. The next time you boot your machine, the same profile will be applied.